

## *Notification of New JETRO Regional and Analysis Reports (October 8, 2026 Issue)*

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Thank you for using JETRO Members Service.

We are pleased to provide you with information on new regional and analysis reports that JETRO conducts from its unique perspective on political and economic trends in major countries and regions worldwide. We hope you will find these reports useful.

### ◆Contents◆

[Special Feature] Diversifying Consumer Images in Asia-Pacific

– Deciphering Values, Lifestyles, and Market Opportunities

In the Asia-Pacific region, consumer needs and purchasing behaviors are becoming increasingly diverse due to rising incomes, advancing urbanization, and digitalization. While these changes vary by country, common trends are also emerging. This special feature examines market trends in major ASEAN countries, India, and Bangladesh, and analyzes how consumers find value, what consumption characteristics they possess, and what factors determine their purchasing decisions, together with case studies of Japanese companies operating locally. By cross-referencing cases across countries and sectors, we identify market opportunities and hints for business expansion for Japanese companies.

◇Thailand (1) Diversifying Values and Selective Consumption

◇Thailand (2) Pet Market Supported by Familiarization and Trust

◇Thailand (3) New Consumer Image from the Healthcare Market Perspective

[Special Feature] Turbulent Middle East Situation: Impact on and Outlook for Middle Eastern Countries <Additional Articles>

Due to the destabilization of the Middle East situation, the business environment surrounding companies operating in the region is undergoing major changes. This special feature examines the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) region by tracking recent trends in logistics and trade, various industries, and corporate initiatives, while also investigating and analyzing government responses and economic policies according to the situation. Through these analyses, we clarify geopolitical risks in the MENA region and new market opportunities from multiple perspectives, introducing a wide range of information to support Japanese companies' future Middle East business ventures.

◇Possibilities for UAE and Sharjah

◇Turbulent Iraq (2) Prime Minister Zeidi Visits US and Iran, Pursuing Balanced Diplomacy

◇Turbulent Iraq (3) Prime Minister Zeidi Visits Turkey, Multilayering Foreign Relations

## ◇Iraqi Crude Oil Exports Under Hormuz Crisis (2) Remaining Challenges in Building Alternative Routes

[Special Feature] Global and Regional Trends Toward Securing Energy Security

<Additional Articles>

Rising tensions in regional geopolitics surrounding conflicts between Israel, the US, and Iran are causing serious disruptions shaking the global energy supply and demand structure. Beyond supply constraints, this situation is placing significant burdens on manufacturing, consumption, and the global economy as a whole. Against this backdrop, attention is focused on whether shortages and rising prices of crude oil and natural gas will lead to accelerated adoption of renewable energy and expanded use of biofuels, or whether continued dependence on fossil fuels will persist. This special feature focuses on diversification of procurement sources and alternative procurement trends, while introducing broadly the progress of energy policies in various countries, the impact these policies have on corporate activities, and corporate responses.

## ◇How Middle East Tensions are Changing Global Energy Strategy (Global)

[Asia - Philippines] Record New Car Sales Yet Production Declines

Sedans Waning as Chinese EVs Rise

Philippines' 2025 new car sales increased from the previous year, marking the third consecutive record high. However, while imported vehicle sales grew, domestic production declined. Sales trends diverged between passenger vehicles such as sedans and hatchbacks, and commercial vehicles including multi-purpose vehicles (MPVs), sport utility vehicles (SUVs), and pickup trucks. Additionally, Chinese EV manufacturers' presence increased. While sales expansion continues, market demand has shifted from sedan-focused to MPV/SUV-focused, revealing mismatches with existing local production systems.

[Asia - China] Shandong Province's Industrial Robot Exports to Japan: The Reality of Expansion

Industrial robot exports from China's Shandong Province to Japan have expanded rapidly in recent years. Export value increased from \$10,324 in 2019 to nearly \$950,000 in 2024, with Japan-bound shipments accounting for close to 5.5% of China's total exports to Japan. However, 2025 saw a decline compared to the previous year, indicating growth is not simply linear, with significant year-to-year fluctuations. Meanwhile, Japan's share of China's overall industrial robot exports dropped from 6.6% in 2022 to 2.9% in 2025, indicating the Japanese market is not driving expanded exports.